9.1.1 The big picture

A node in a sharded cluster can create shard regions (SRs) that contain shards, which in turn contain distributed entities. Shards are groups of entities: the number of shards is determined by the configuration, and their content is determined by the sharding function mentioned previously. SRs contain shards and are responsible for routing messages to entities. These relationships are shown in figure 9.1.

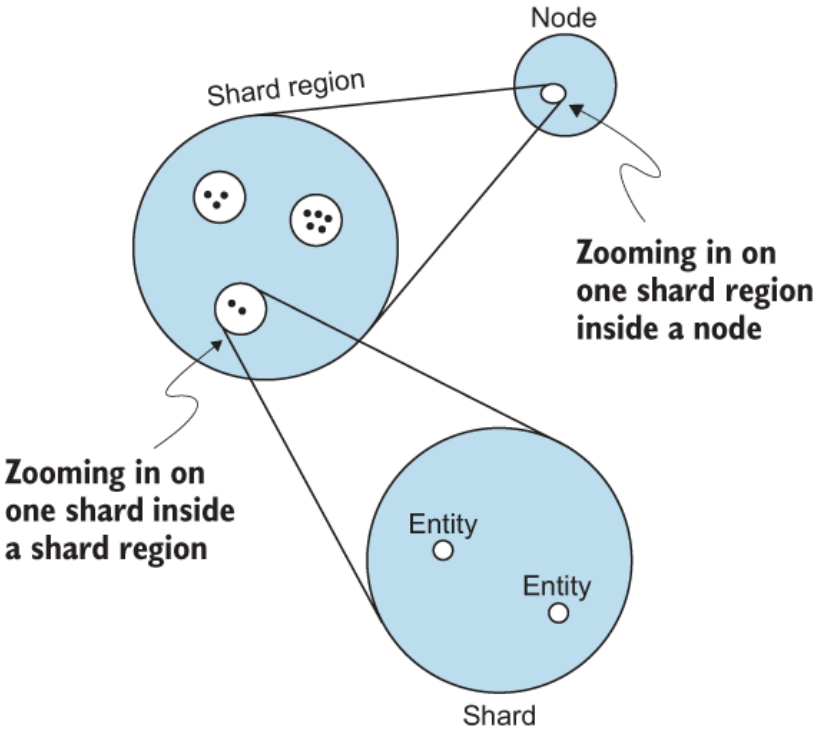


Figure 9.1 Relationships among nodes, shared regions, shards, and entities

Which shards belong to which SR and how to find the entities is ultimately managed by the shard coordinator (SC). Figure 9.2 shows all of these sharding components.